

Kefan Yu

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Education **Northwestern University**, Evanston, IL *2022 - 2026 (Expected)*
B.S. Computer Science

Research Interests

- Evaluation and Interpretability of LLMs
- Computational Linguistics
- Natural Language Processing

Publications **Kefan Yu***, Qingcheng Zeng*, Weihao Xuan, Wanxin Li, Jingyi Wu, Rob Voigt, 2025, [The Pragmatic Mind of Machines: Tracing the Emergence of Pragmatic Competence in Large Language Models](#), *In Proceedings of the 19th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL), 2026. To appear.*
(*: equal contribution)

Research Appointments **Toyota Technological Institute at Chicago** *June 2025 - Present*
Research Assistant

- Working with [Zhewei Sun](#)
- Leading an ongoing project on multilingual slang generation.

MLL-Lab, Northwestern University *Jan 2025 - Present*
Intern

- Working with [Zihan Wang](#) and [Manling Li](#)
- Designed and produced publication-quality figures and experimental settings.
- Conducted comprehensive experimental evaluation for the RAGEN framework.

LingMechLab, Northwestern University*Feb 2024 - Present**Research Assistant*

- Working with [Qingcheng Zeng](#) and [Rob Voigt](#)
- Executed data preprocessing protocols and performed dataset annotation to support research initiatives.
- Led the development of the AltPrag paper, including dataset creation, experiments, figures, and writing contributions.

Teaching**CS336: Design & Analysis of Algorithms***Spring 2025**Peer Mentor***CS449: Deep Learning***Winter 2024**Peer Mentor***Industry****CDK Global**, Hoffman Estates, IL*June 2024 – Aug 2024***Experience***Software Engineer Intern***Awards****Dean's List**, Northwestern University*2023 – 2025***Skills****Tools & Packages***Python, Linux, Conda, Jupyter, Git, Pytorch, Numpy, Huggingface***Language***Mandarin (native), English (proficient), Japanese (intermediate)*